

Vincent Winterhager

Policy Officer, Chief Economist Unit (DG BUDG), European Commission · Lecturer, Hertie School

Brussels, Belgium · vincentwinterhager@gmail.com · [linkedin.com/in/vincent-winterhager](https://www.linkedin.com/in/vincent-winterhager)

Profile

Economist and policy officer working at the intersection of European fiscal policy, political economy, and applied econometrics. Current focus on the EU budget and the next Multiannual Financial Framework (MFF) in the Chief Economist Unit of DG BUDG, alongside graduate teaching on the political economy of common debt at the Hertie School.

Interests: EU budget & MFF · common debt & EU bonds · European Monetary Union · fiscal policy · energy & climate policy · econometrics & data science.

Experience

Feb 2026 – present	Policy Officer — Chief Economist Unit (DG BUDG) European Commission, Brussels ▶ Strengthening the econometric evidence base on the EU budget together with the Joint Research Centre. ▶ Informing decision-makers on the design of the next Multiannual Financial Framework (MFF).
Apr 2024 – Feb 2026	Policy Officer — Ukraine Directorate (DG ENEST) European Commission, Economic Analysis Unit ▶ Coordinated the G7+ Energy Group for Ukraine. ▶ Economic analysis of energy-sector state-owned enterprises, the impact of CBAM on Ukrainian industry, and public debt, inflation and budgetary needs. ▶ Responsible for the energy and climate reforms of the Ukraine Facility (ETS, Electricity Integration Package, TSO/DSO reform). ▶ Led the Ukraine Rapid Damage and Needs Assessment (RDNA) jointly with the World Bank.
Apr 2023 – Apr 2024	Policy Officer — Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF) European Commission, Secretariat-General ▶ Focus on energy and climate investments; responsible for the national plans of Estonia and Belgium. ▶ Coordinated REPowerEU negotiations with Member States.
Oct 2022 – Feb 2023	Blue Book Trainee — Recovery and Resilience Facility European Commission, Secretariat-General
Feb 2025 – present	Lecturer (part-time) Hertie School, Berlin ▶ Graduate seminar on the political economy of common debt in the EU, the future of the MFF, and diverging productivity regimes; co-taught with Johannes Lindner (Jacques Delors Centre).
Jul 2022 – Sep 2022	Visiting Associate, Data Analytics GovMind, Berlin ▶ Integrated EU public-procurement data (TED) via API and R into internal analytics products.
prior	Research & consulting roles OECD · GIZ · PD — Berater der öffentlichen Hand
since 2014	Founder — WIN-IT Webdesign & IT-Beratung Self-employed ▶ Web development and IT project planning for SMEs, civil-society organisations and entrepreneurs.

Education

2021 – 2022	MPA, London School of Economics (LSE) Dual degree with the Hertie School ▶ Econometrics (DiD, IV, RDD, RCTs, OLS, synthetic control), labour economics, economics of European monetary integration, applied machine learning. ▶ Capstone practice project with the EBRD (awarded to one student of the Hertie cohort).
2020 – 2021	MPP, Hertie School (final grade 1.4) Dual degree with LSE — Policy Analysis concentration ▶ International political economy and competition policy; advanced statistics. ▶ Project course with DG Competition on detecting market dominance in the digital sector; final paper selected for publication.

Publications

- ▶ Winterhager, V., et al. (2026). *Fifth Rapid Damage and Needs Assessment (RDNA 5)*. World Bank & European Commission. [\[PDF\]](#)
- ▶ Winterhager, V., et al. (2023). *Reshaping Decentralised Development Cooperation in Germany*. OECD. [\[PDF\]](#)

Teaching

since 2025	The Political Economy of the EU Budget & Common Debt Hertie School — MPP graduate seminar
ongoing	Lectures on economic policy Friedrich Ebert Foundation — EU fiscal rules, EMU, climate & fiscal policy

Awards, Fellowships & Certificates

2021	Fellowship of the Friedrich Ebert Foundation Full scholarship for studies at the Hertie School and LSE
2025	Financing and Investing in Infrastructure Università Bocconi — certificate
2020	McKinsey Firsthand Programme

Service

2022	Co-Founder — Friends of Medyka NGO supporting refugees at the Polish–Ukrainian border
since 2021	Student representative — Friedrich Ebert Foundation London, Oxford & Cambridge

Skills

Econometrics	DiD, IV, RDD, RCTs, OLS, synthetic control, calibration
Programming	R, data science, applied machine learning
Languages	German (native), English (fluent)